They are…

1. Establishing a foundation of law
2. Maintaining macroeconomic stability
3. Investing in basic social services and infrastructure
4. Protecting the vulnerable
5. Protecting the environment

6.7 The Concept of Governance from Government to Governance

Good governance is an indeterminate term used in the international development literature to describe how public institutions conduct public affairs and manage public resources. Governance is "the process of decision-making and the process by which decisions are implemented". "Government" and "governance" are synonyms, both denoting the exercise of authority in an organization, institution or state. Government and governance became distinguished along the following dimensions:

a. What activities are encompassed in the act of governing?
b. What actors are involved in governance?
c. What processes have made this redefinition necessary?
d. What criteria are used to evaluate good governance?
e. What capacities should be developed to achieve it?

Governance is the exercise of political, economic and administrative authority to manage a nation's affairs…Governance embraces all of the methods – good and bad– that societies use to distribute power and manage public sources and problems (UNDP, 1997):

Governance is the manner in which power is exercised in the management of a country's social and economic resources for development (ADB, 2000) The movement from government to governance is not merely a task of creating new institutions but also that of refurbishing old ones. The state has to be strengthened to play a new role. It is also for the civil society to accept that democracy is not going to polls every five years but being vigilant and monitoring institutional performance and holding them accountable throughout these years.

Partnership with civil society

In the shift of government to governance the role of civil society has been very significant. There have been two kinds of strands in this role,

a. Social Movements
b. Non-Governmental Organizations

Social Movements which works for the cause of poor and marginalized do influence the governments to be responsive to their needs through changes in institutions, laws and procedures. NGO's have taken up diverse roles that also involve implementation of government programmes. Social movements and NGO's occupied new spaces in the political process and delivering public services.

From Government to Governance



Governance
- Collaborative
- Flexible
- Open
- Innovative
- Risk-taking
- Of the People
- Intentional

ACTIVITY

Cartoons cape Thinking about a global perspective

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